

Application layer: overview

- Principles of network applications
- Web and HTTP
- **E-mail, SMTP, IMAP**
- The Domain Name System DNS
- P2P applications
- video streaming and content distribution networks
- socket programming with UDP and TCP



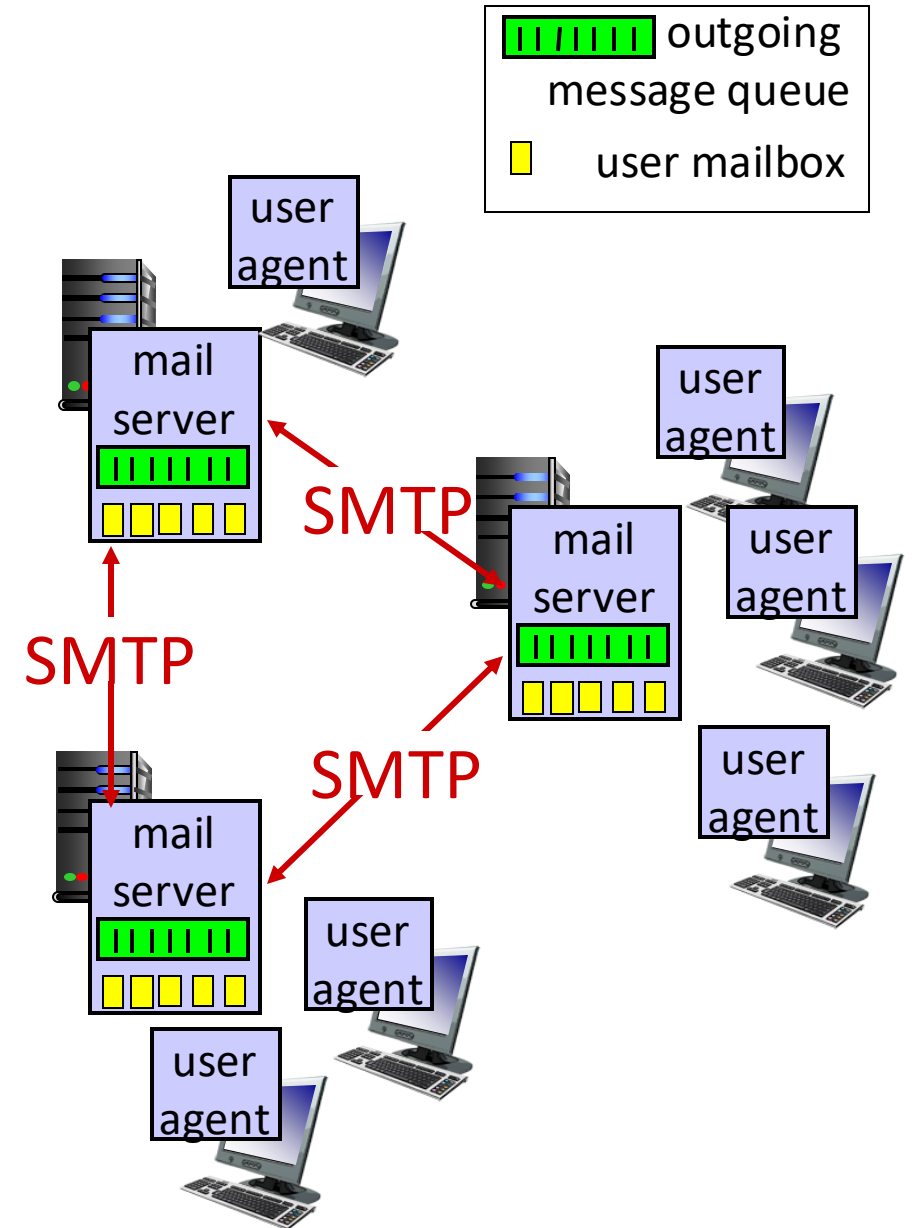
E-mail

Three major components:

- user agents
- mail servers
- simple mail transfer protocol: SMTP

User Agent

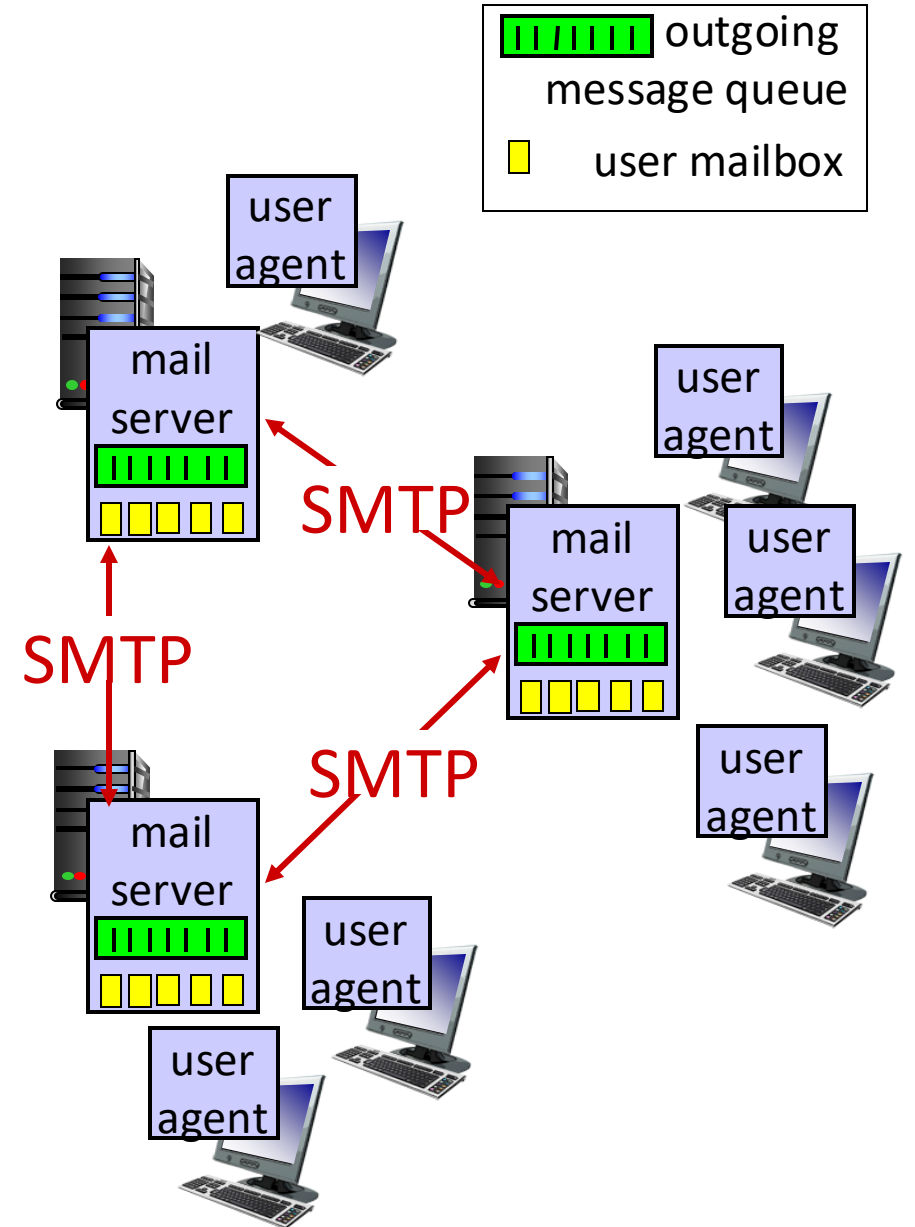
- a.k.a. “mail reader”
- composing, editing, reading mail messages
- e.g., Outlook, iPhone mail client
- outgoing, incoming messages stored on server



E-mail: mail servers

mail servers:

- *mailbox* contains incoming messages for user
- *message queue* of outgoing (to be sent) mail messages
- *SMTP protocol* between mail servers to send email messages
 - client: sending mail server
 - “server”: receiving mail server

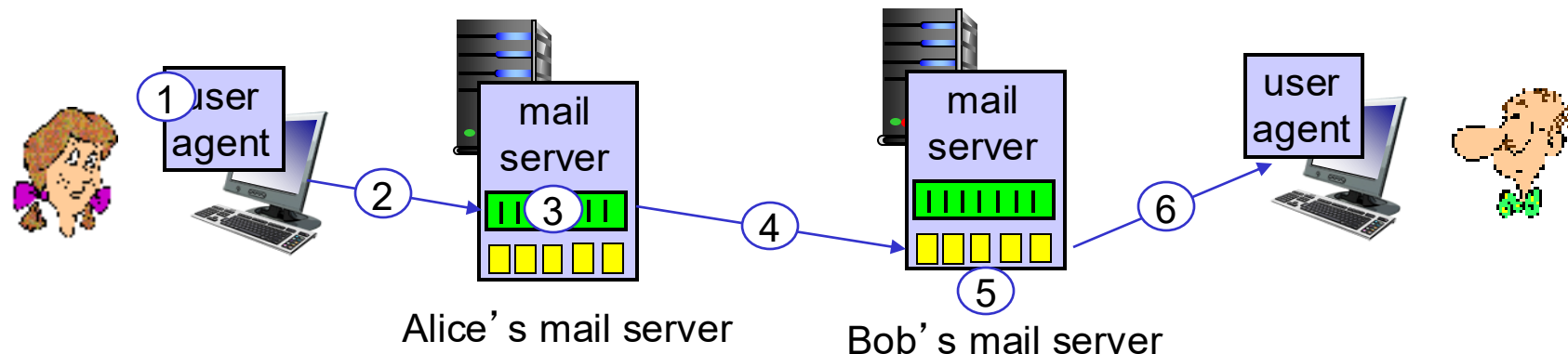


E-mail: the RFC (5321)

- uses **TCP to reliably transfer email message** from client (mail server initiating connection) to server, port 25
- direct transfer: sending server (acting like client) to receiving server
- three phases of transfer
 - handshaking (greeting)
 - transfer of messages
 - closure
- command/response interaction (like HTTP)
 - **commands**: ASCII text
 - **response**: status code and phrase
- messages must be in 7-bit ASCII

Scenario: Alice sends e-mail to Bob

- 1) Alice uses UA to compose e-mail message "to" bob@some school.edu
- 2) Alice's UA sends message to her mail server; message placed in message queue
- 3) client side of SMTP opens TCP connection with Bob's mail server
- 4) SMTP client sends Alice's message over the TCP connection
- 5) Bob's mail server places the message in Bob's mailbox
- 6) Bob invokes his user agent to read message



Sample SMTP interaction

```
S: 220 hamburger.edu
C: HELO crepes.fr
S: 250 Hello crepes.fr, pleased to meet you
C: MAIL FROM: <alice@crepes.fr>
S: 250 alice@crepes.fr... Sender ok
C: RCPT TO: <bob@hamburger.edu>
S: 250 bob@hamburger.edu ... Recipient ok
C: DATA
S: 354 Enter mail, end with "." on a line by itself
C: Do you like ketchup?
C: How about pickles?
C: .
S: 250 Message accepted for delivery
C: QUIT
S: 221 hamburger.edu closing connection
```

Try SMTP interaction for yourself:

telnet <servername> 25

- see 220 reply from server
- enter HELO, MAIL FROM:, RCPT TO:, DATA, QUIT commands

above lets you send email without using e-mail client (reader)

Note: this will only work if <servername> allows telnet connections to port 25 (this is becoming increasingly rare because of security concerns)

SMTP: closing observations

comparison with HTTP:

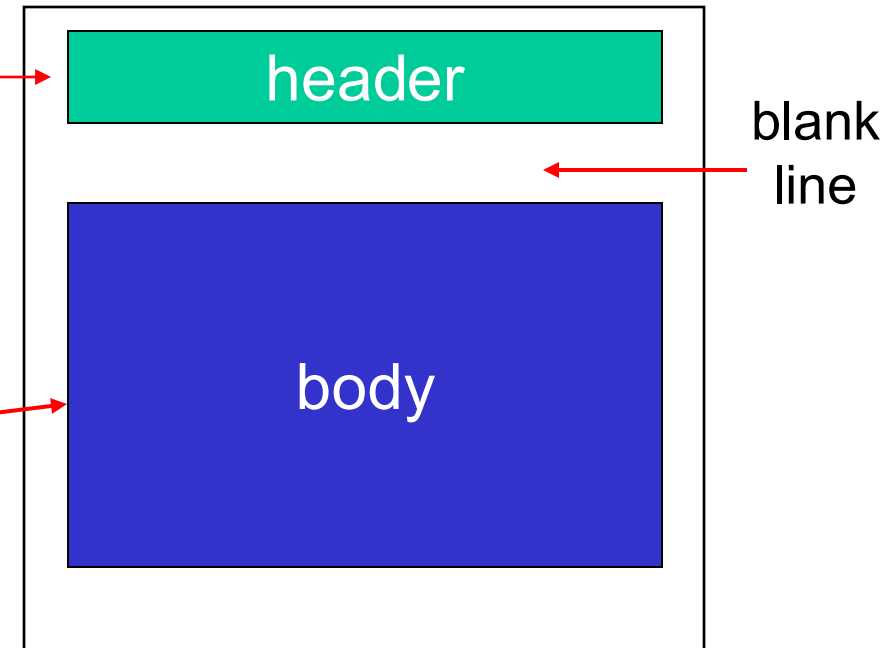
- HTTP: **pull**
- SMTP: **push**
- both have ASCII command/response interaction, status codes
- HTTP: each object encapsulated in its own response message
- SMTP: multiple objects sent in multipart message
- SMTP uses persistent connections
- SMTP requires message (header & body) to be in 7-bit ASCII
- SMTP server uses CRLF.CRLF to determine end of message

Mail message format

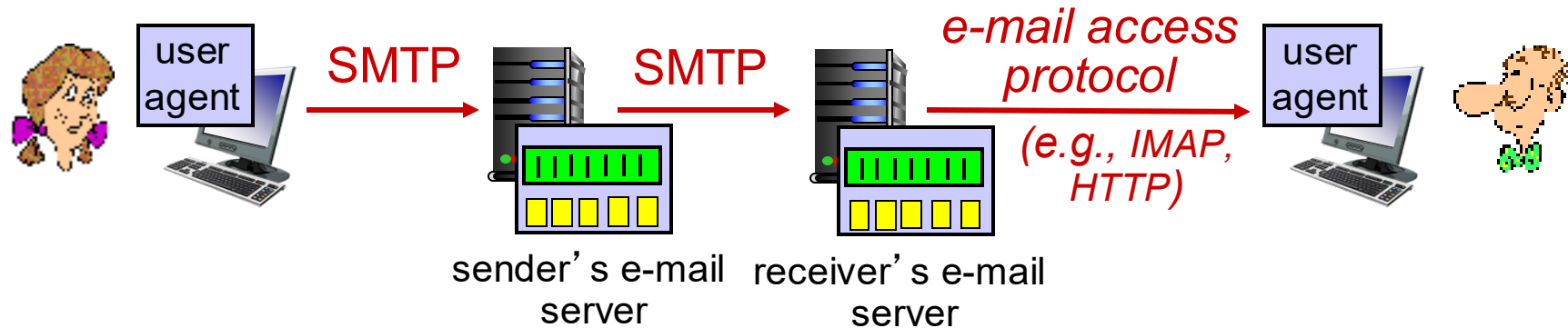
SMTP: protocol for exchanging e-mail messages, defined in **RFC 531** (like HTTP)

RFC 822 defines *syntax* for e-mail message itself (like HTML)

- header lines, e.g.,
 - To:
 - From:
 - Subject:these lines, within the body of the email message area different from SMTP MAIL FROM:, RCPT TO: commands!
- Body: the “message” , ASCII characters only

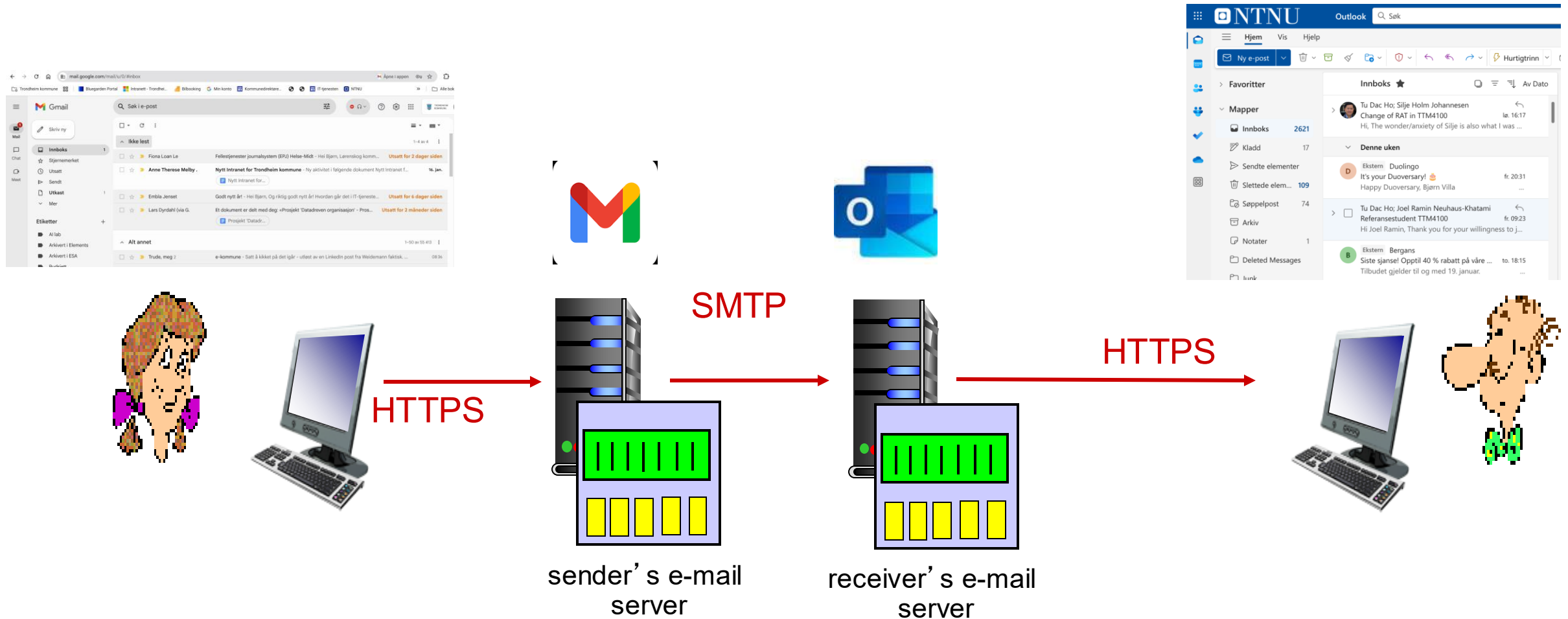


Mail access protocols



- **SMTP:** delivery/storage of e-mail messages to receiver's server
- mail access protocol: retrieval from server
 - **IMAP:** Internet Mail Access Protocol [RFC 3501]: messages stored on server, IMAP provides retrieval, deletion, folders of stored messages on server
- **HTTP:** gmail, Hotmail, Yahoo!Mail, etc. provides web-based interface on top of SMTP (to send), IMAP (or POP) to retrieve e-mail messages

Men det er jo egentlig mer sånn idag....



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DNS: Domain Name System

people: many identifiers:

- SSN, name, passport #

Internet hosts, routers:

- IP address (32 bit) - used for addressing datagrams
- “name”, e.g., cs.umass.edu - used by humans

Q: how to map between IP address and name, and vice versa ?

Domain Name System:

- *distributed database* implemented in hierarchy of many *name servers*
- *application-layer protocol:* hosts, name servers communicate to *resolve* names (address/name translation)
 - note: core Internet function, *implemented as application-layer protocol*
 - complexity at network’s “edge”

DNS: services, structure

DNS services

- hostname to IP address translation
- host aliasing
 - canonical, alias names
- mail server aliasing
- load distribution
 - replicated Web servers: many IP addresses correspond to one name

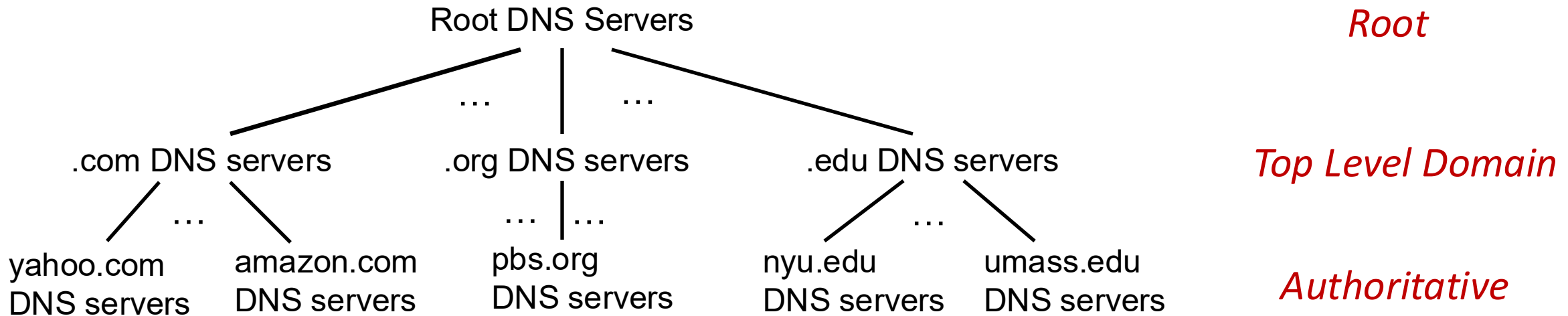
Q: Why not centralize DNS?

- single point of failure
- traffic volume
- distant centralized database
- maintenance

A: doesn't scale!

- Comcast DNS servers alone: 600B DNS queries per day

DNS: a distributed, hierarchical database



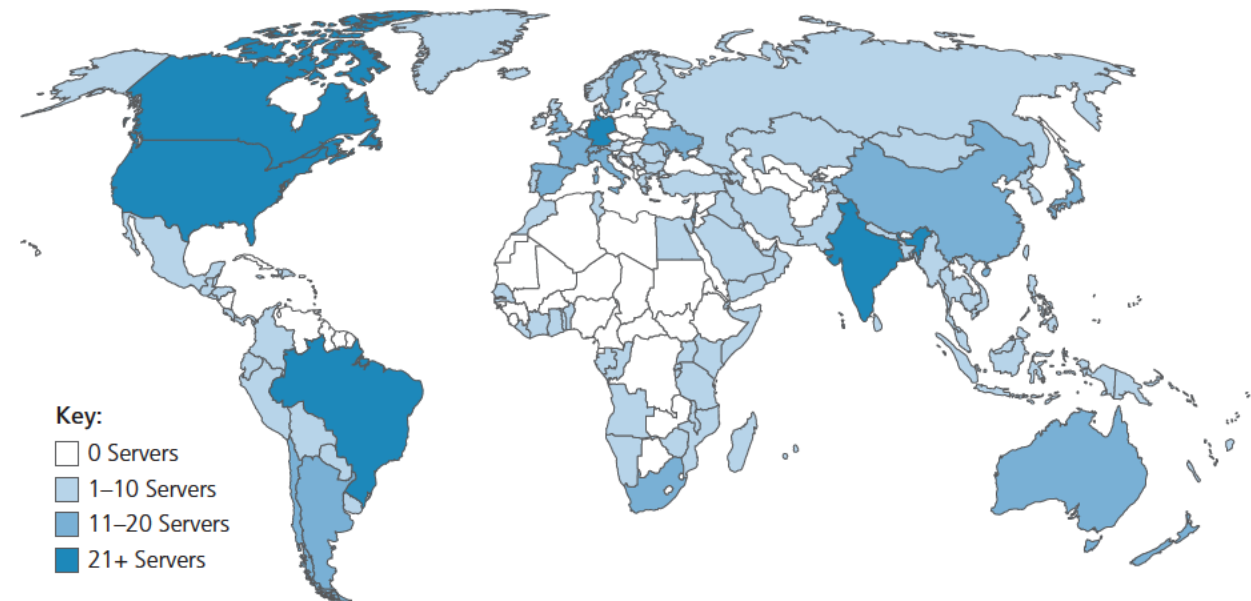
Client wants IP address for `www.amazon.com`; 1st approximation:

- client queries root server to find `.com` DNS server
- client queries `.com` DNS server to get `amazon.com` DNS server
- client queries `amazon.com` DNS server to get IP address for `www.amazon.com`

DNS: root name servers

- official, contact-of-last-resort by name servers that can not resolve name
- *incredibly important* Internet function
 - Internet couldn't function without it!
 - DNSSEC – provides security (authentication and message integrity)
- ICANN (Internet Corporation for Assigned Names and Numbers) manages root DNS domain

13 logical root name “servers”
worldwide each “server” replicated
many times (~200 servers in US, more
than 1000 worldwide)



TLD: authoritative servers

Top-Level Domain (TLD) servers:

- responsible for .com, .org, .net, .edu, .aero, .jobs, .museums, and all top-level country domains, e.g.: .cn, .uk, .fr, .ca, .jp
- Network Solutions: authoritative registry for .com, .net TLD
- Educause: .edu TLD

Authoritative DNS servers:

- organization's own DNS server(s), providing authoritative hostname to IP mappings for organization's named hosts
- can be maintained by organization or service provider

Local DNS name servers

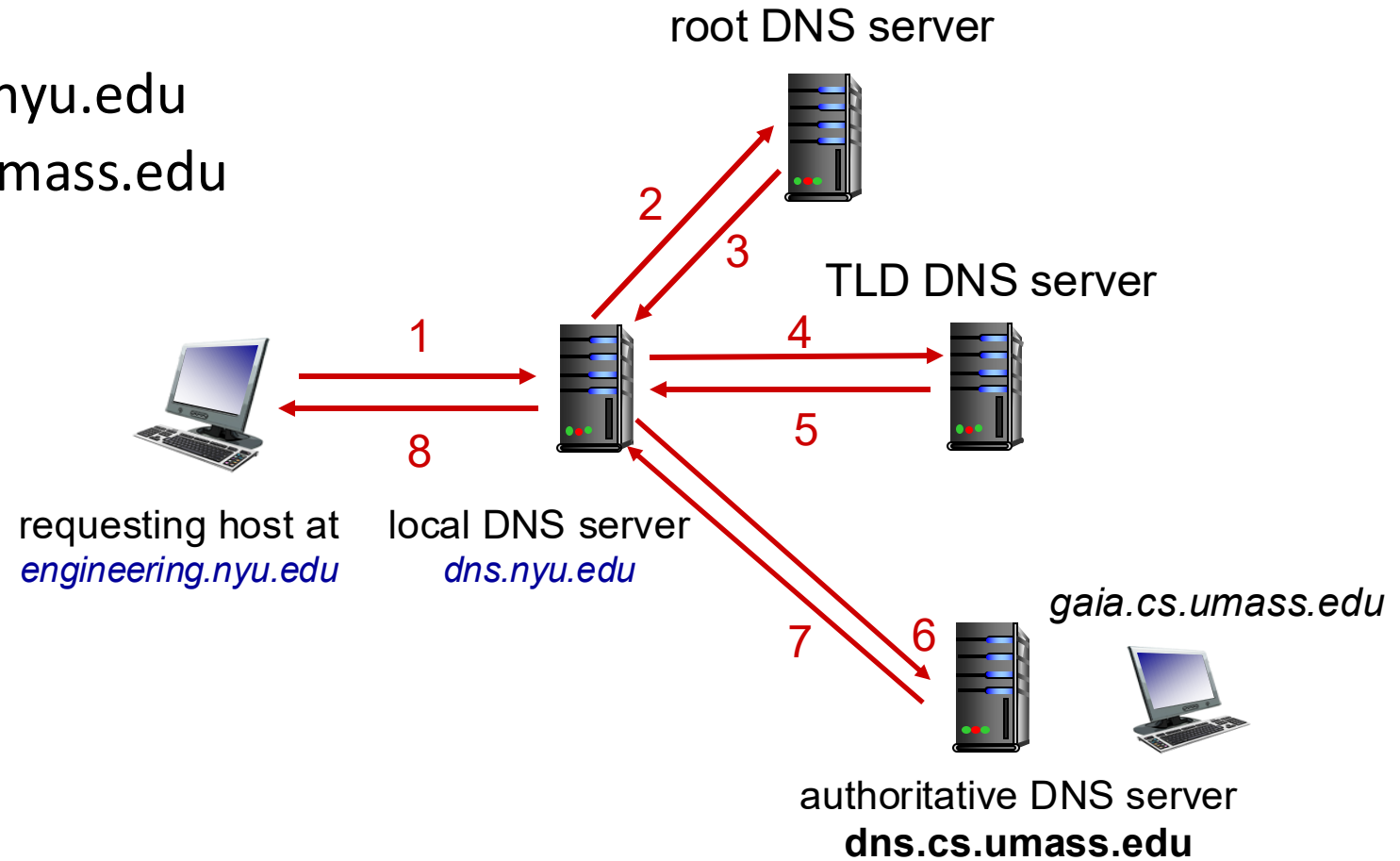
- does not strictly belong to hierarchy
- each ISP (residential ISP, company, university) has one
 - also called “default name server”
- when host makes DNS query, query is sent to its local DNS server
 - has local cache of recent name-to-address translation pairs (but may be out of date!)
 - acts as proxy, forwards query into hierarchy

DNS name resolution: iterated query

Example: host at `engineering.nyu.edu` wants IP address for `gaia.cs.umass.edu`

Iterated query:

- contacted server replies with name of server to contact
- “I don’t know this name, but ask this server”

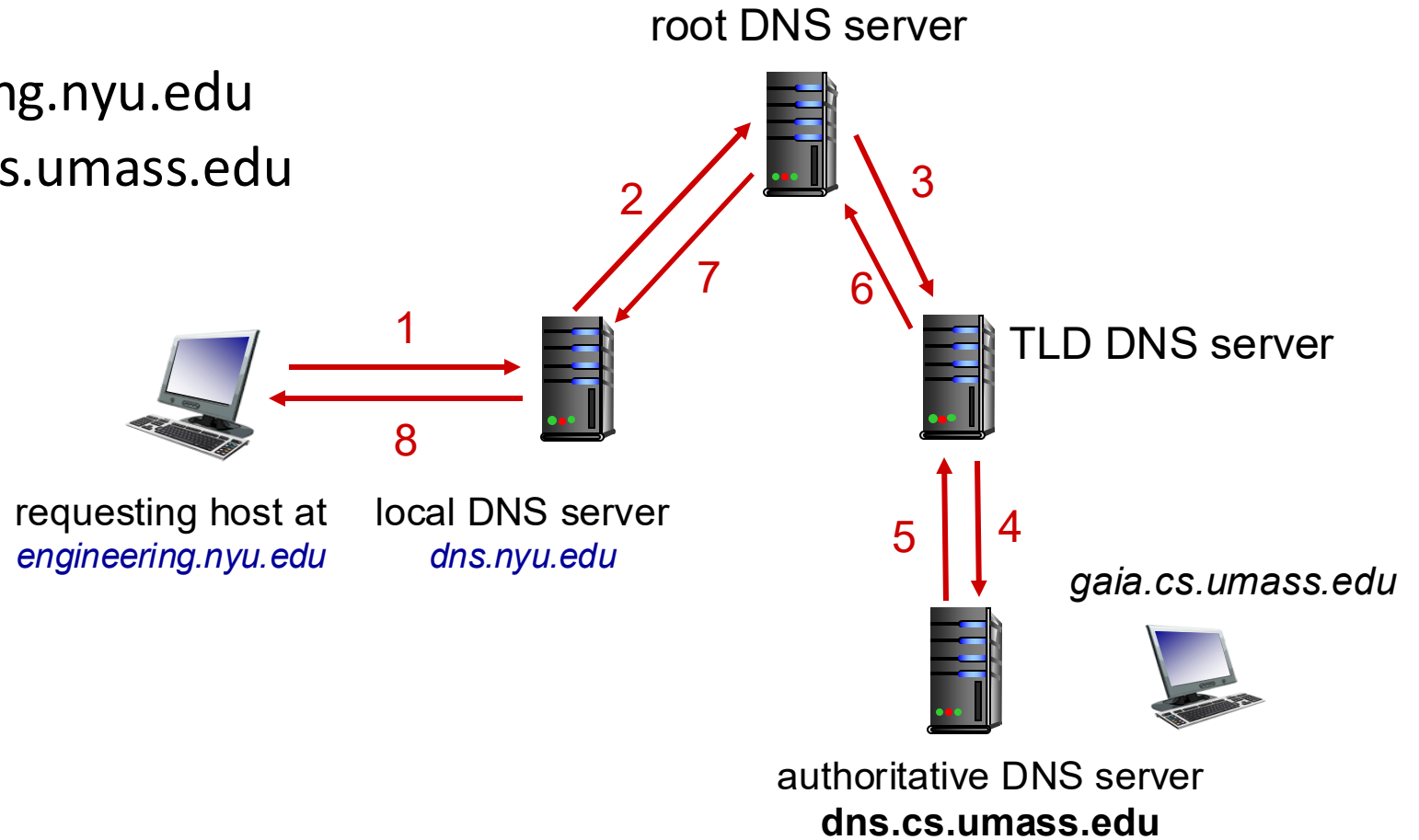


DNS name resolution: recursive query (default)

Example: host at `engineering.nyu.edu` wants IP address for `gaia.cs.umass.edu`

Recursive query:

- puts burden of name resolution on contacted name server
- heavy load at upper levels of hierarchy
- Commonly used as part of DNSsec



Caching, Updating DNS Records

- once (any) name server learns mapping, it *cached* mapping
 - cache entries timeout (disappear) after some time (TTL)
 - TLD servers typically cached in local name servers
- cached entries may be *out-of-date* (best-effort name-to-address translation!)
 - if name host changes IP address, may not be known Internet-wide until all TTLs expire!
- update/notify mechanisms proposed IETF standard
 - RFC 2136

DNS records

DNS: distributed database storing resource records (**RR**)

RR format: (**name**, **value**, **type**, **ttl**)

type=A

- name is hostname
- value is IP address

type=NS

- name is domain (e.g., foo.com)
- value is hostname of authoritative name server for this domain

type=CNAME

- name is alias name for some “canonical” (the real) name
- www.ibm.com is really servereast.backup2.ibm.com
- value is canonical name

type=MX

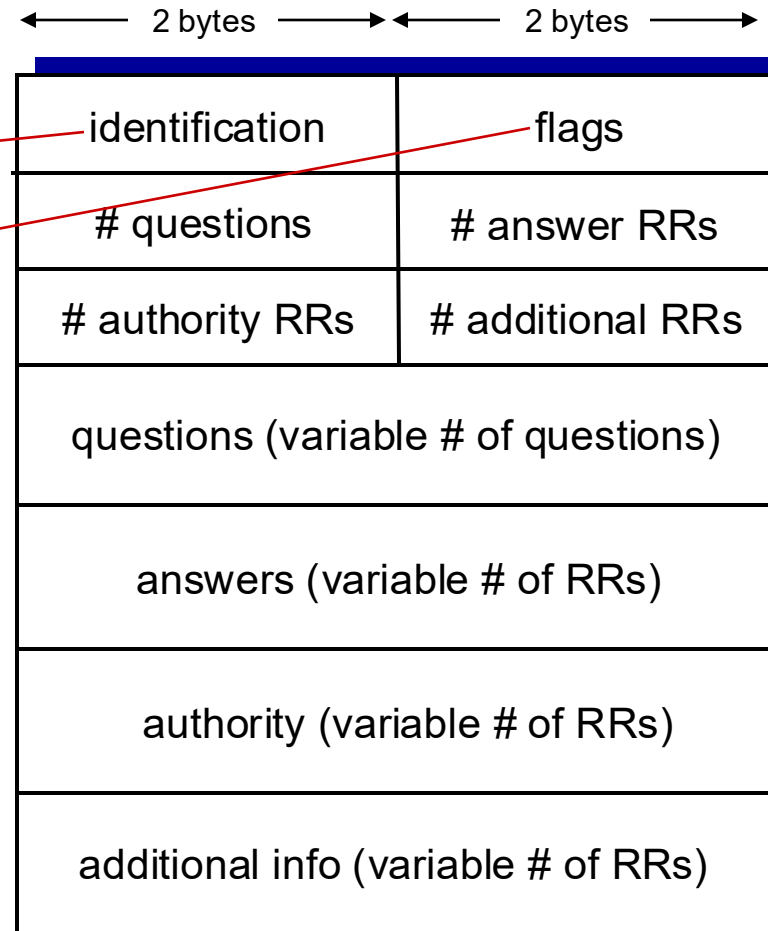
- value is name of mailserver associated with name

DNS protocol messages

DNS *query* and *reply* messages, both have same *format*:

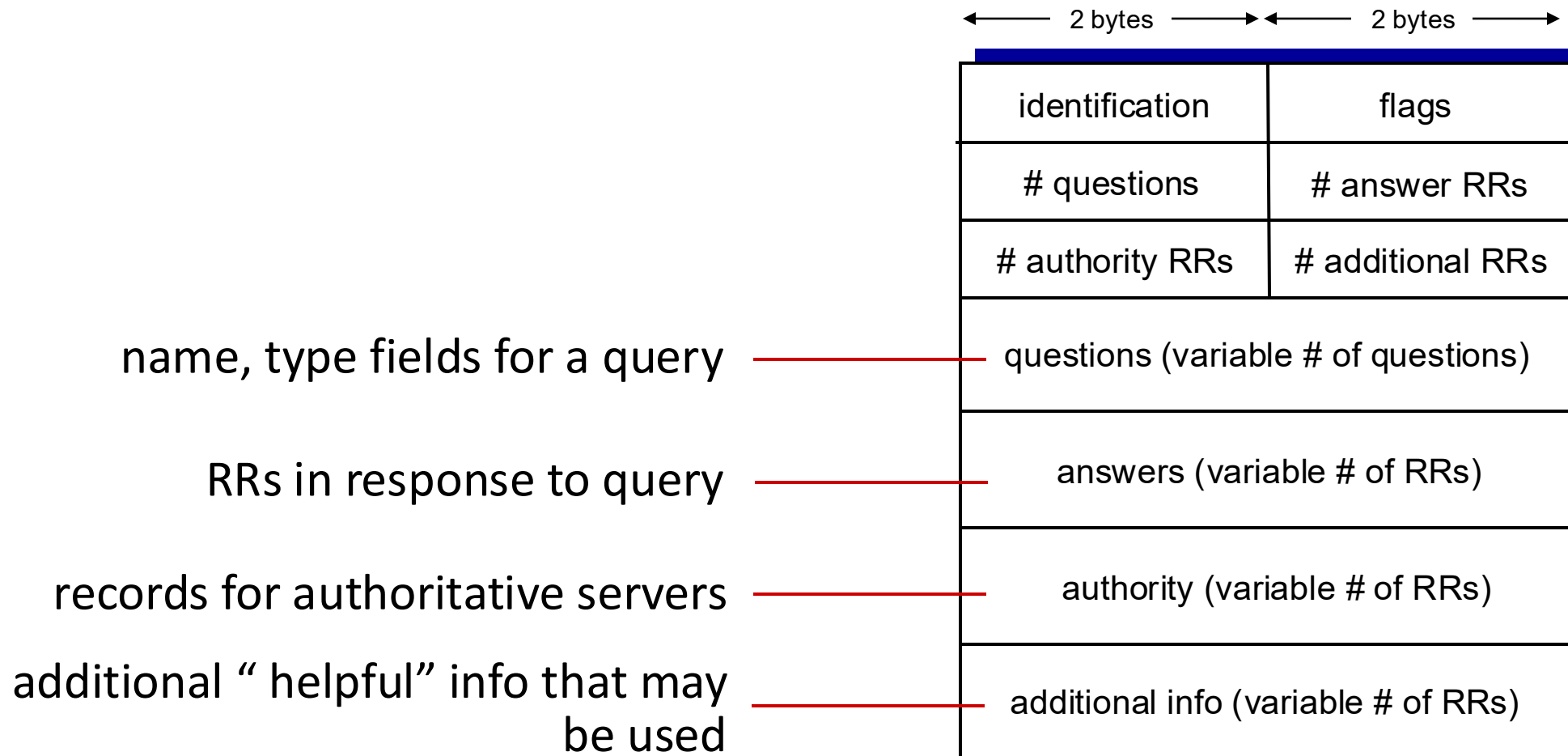
message header:

- **identification**: 16 bit # for query, reply to query uses same #
- **flags**:
 - query or reply
 - recursion desired
 - recursion available
 - reply is authoritative



DNS protocol messages

DNS *query* and *reply* messages, both have same *format*:



DNS protocol messages

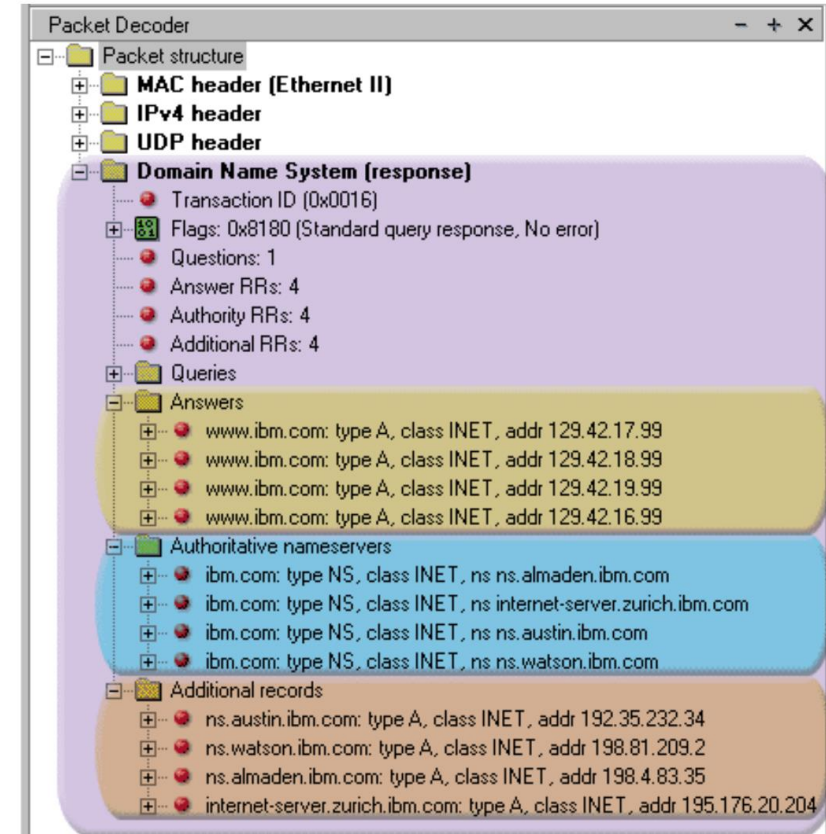
reply message

RRs in response to query

records for authoritative servers

additional “helpful” info that may
be used

To help make this clear, we also captured a DNS Response packet from a DNS query for the domain **ibm.com**:



As it is evident, our query for IBM.COM gave us a response which has 4 answers per section!

Inserting records into DNS

Example: new startup “Network Utopia”

- register name networkutopia.com at *DNS registrar* (e.g., Network Solutions)
 - provide names, IP addresses of authoritative name server (primary and secondary)
 - registrar inserts NS, A RRs into .com **TLD server**:
(networkutopia.com, dns1.networkutopia.com, NS)
(dns1.networkutopia.com, 212.212.212.1, A)
- create **authoritative server locally** with IP address 212.212.212.1
 - type A record for www.networkutopia.com
 - type MX record for networkutopia.com

RR format: (name, value, (type), ttl)

type=A

- name is hostname
- value is IP address

type=NS

- name is domain (e.g., foo.com)
- value is hostname of authoritative name server for this domain

type=CNAME

- name is alias name for some “canonical” (the real) name
- www.ibm.com is really servereast.backup2.ibm.com
- value is canonical name

type=MX

- value is name of mailserver associated with name

DNS security

DDoS attacks

- bombard root servers with traffic
 - not successful to date
 - traffic filtering
 - local DNS servers cache IPs of TLD servers, allowing root server bypass
- bombard TLD servers
 - potentially more dangerous

Redirect attacks

- man-in-middle
 - intercept DNS queries
- DNS poisoning
 - send bogus replies to DNS server, which caches

Exploit DNS for DDoS

- send queries with spoofed source address: target IP
- requires amplification

DNSSEC
[RFC 4033]